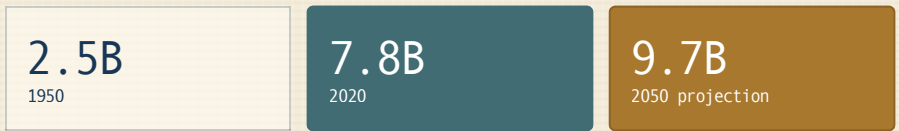


THE STATE OF THE WORLD IN OUR GENERATION

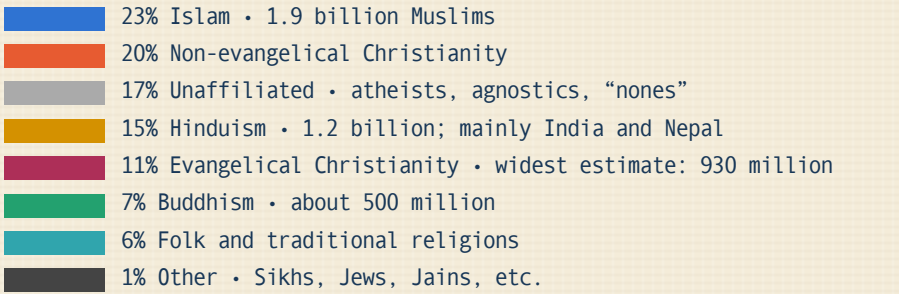
PREPARED FOR THE
VISION MISSIONS CONFERENCE 2026
SEPTEMBER 2ND-6TH, 2026

THE GROWTH OF WORLD POPULATION



World population has more than tripled since 1950 and is projected to approach 9.7 billion by 2050.

MAJOR WORLD RELIGIONS



Nehemiah 1:4 “And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven”

Notes

STATUS OF WORLD EVANGELIZATION

World population: 8.3 billion, 2026

11%	0.91 billion • Christ-followers
21%	1.74 billion • Nominal Christian
40%	3.32 billion • Heard, not responded
28%	2.32 billion • Virtually no exposure

THE 10/40 WINDOW

More than 90% of the world’s unreached peoples live across North Africa, the Middle East, and Asia.

India Dozens of unreached peoples	Middle East and North Africa Egypt, Morocco, Iraq, Yemen, Saudi Arabia and more
Bangladesh Bengali Muslims, roughly 135 million	Central Asia Kazakhstan, Azerbaijan, Afghanistan
Pakistan Large Jat and Arain populations	Indonesia The world’s largest Muslim population
China and Japan Hundreds of groups; Japan under 2% evangelical	West Africa Hausa, Fulani, Kanuri and Bambara peoples

FIVE OPENED DOORS

Communist collapse. A dictator's death. Genocide. Political upheaval. Each nation was closed to open Christian witness within living memory, and each has since come open.

MONGOLIA

40,000+ evangelicals today, from almost none in 1990. Communist rule ended that year.

ALBANIA

17,000 believers today; constitutionally atheist from 1967 until 1990-91.

NEPAL

11% yearly evangelical growth since Nepal became a secular republic in 2008.

CAMBODIA

290,000+ evangelicals, growing about 9% yearly since the Khmer Rouge fell.

SOUTH KOREA

16-20% evangelical today and among the world's leading missionary-sending nations.

OPERATION WORLD, 7TH EDITION

“Who among us, 30 years ago, could have envisioned over 100 million Chinese Christians, massive people movements in Iran, Algeria and Sudan, breakthroughs in Mozambique, Cambodia and Nepal... Only God!”

“For a great door and effectual is opened unto me, and there are many adversaries.”

1 CORINTHIANS 16:9

Source: Operation World (2010) and current field estimates.

BIBLE TRANSLATION

Wycliffe Bible Translators estimates that of the 7,394 languages spoken worldwide, only 522 are still considered vital for translation work.

7,394

languages spoken today

522

languages still vital
for translation work •
about 37 million people

99%

of the world has access to
some Scripture in its own
language

THE CENTRE OF GRAVITY HAS MOVED

The world's Christian share is roughly the same as in 1900, but where Christians live has changed completely.

18%

of Christians lived in Africa, Asia
and Latin America in 1900

69%

live in Africa, Asia and Latin America today

“Years and generations of prayer and faithful service to the
unevangelized world... have not been in vain.”

OPERATION WORLD

THE GLOBALIZATION OF MISSIONS

GAINING MOMENTUM

- Ethiopia, Nigeria
- Brazil
- Philippines, South Korea
- India

LEVEL OR DECLINING

- North America
- Europe
- The Pacific

CITIES, MEDIA AND TECHNOLOGY

THE WORLD IS URBANISING FAST

58%

of the world lives in cities, up from 30% in 1950

70%

projected to live in cities by 2050

500+

cities now hold more than a million people

As cities grow, unreached peoples move into them, placing churches in cities like London within reach of peoples from across the world.

“The ‘threat’ of immigration could also be a great opportunity for Christian ministry.”

OPERATION WORLD

WHERE MISSIONARIES CANNOT GO, TECHNOLOGY CAN

MOBILE PHONES

Evangelism, discipleship and training in the hand.

SATELLITE INTERNET

Connection across geographic barriers.

RADIO BROADCASTS

Content reaching closed and remote regions.

APPS & STREAMING

Scalable Scripture, teaching and discipleship.

Technology and AI may shorten translation timelines and help mission agencies deploy resources more strategically. The possibilities are limited by Christian creativity and commitment.

LOOK ON THE HARVEST

1.47B

INDIA

The world's largest country; about 1.1 billion people in "frontier" unreached groups with no known indigenous Christian community.

Pray

For Indian churches, national missionaries, and workers navigating visa and ministry restrictions.

1.41B

CHINA

The world's second-largest country, with 135 cities of more than one million residents.

Pray

For labourers to go and live among the Chinese people.

THE MUSLIM WORLD

Open or fairly open: Senegal, The Gambia, Sierra Leone, Albania, Bosnia, Kyrgyzstan, Azerbaijan, Malaysia, UAE, Djibouti and Kuwait.

Encouraging reports: Iran and Algeria remain oppressive, yet reports of Christian growth are among the most encouraging anywhere.

AFRICA

3.37%

Annual growth in the Central African Republic. Other fast-growing nations include Somalia, Niger, DR Congo, Sudan, Angola, Mali, Tanzania and Mozambique.

PROJECTED BY 2050

Nigeria passes the United States to become the world's 3rd most populous country

DR Congo becomes 8th largest, at about 217 million people

Ethiopia becomes 9th largest, at about 215 million people

WHEN WE HEAR

WE WEEP.
WE PRAY.
WE ASK.
WE GO.

“And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven,”

NEHEMIAH 1:4

“Then the king said unto me, For what dost thou make request? So I prayed to the God of heaven. And I said unto the king... that thou wouldest send me unto Judah... that I may build it.”

NEHEMIAH 2:4-5

PRAY FOR THE WORLD IN OUR GENERATION

- More labourers for the harvest
- Open doors among unreached peoples
- Strength for national churches and missionaries
- Scripture in every remaining language
- A willing answer when God asks, “For what dost thou make request?”